

Dell Streak

Michael Dell, CEO of Dell shows off the new Android powered tablet powered by a 1GHz Snapdragon

Beovision 8

Bang and Olufsen launches the 40-inch Beovision 8 LCD TV priced at \$5400 (Rs. 2.7 lakhs)

Cellphone test



Sony Ericsson Satio

no mean feat.

The Verdict:

Go for the Satio if you need a good camera phone that can do a good job in low-light conditions. It did fairly well in all the tests, with good bundled headphones. However, it is still overpriced, Vivaz is another option, which is also much cheaper.

Conclusion

We were sure that when comparing phones of such caliber, we'd be hard-pressed to declare a clear winner. We weren't too wrong. While the Xperia X10 was almost immediately counted out because of its dated OS and incumbent

lack of applications, the battle between the iPhone 3GS and Motorola Milestone was awesome to behold. Even though the Milestone couldn't compare with the iPhone's now legendary touch-sensitivity, it was stunning in nearly every other respect, and at the end of our testing, came out the not-so-clear winner. For this reason, the iPhone 3GS got our Editor's Pick award, losing out to the Milestone only in a few of our signal reception and the camera tests.

The road ahead

The future is almost here, and we're all eagerly awaiting it. India will get 3G connectivity by September (hopefully), the Windows Phone 7 OS will be out by the end of the year, 4G connectivity has already started being offered (read the HTC EVO 4G on Sprint), and the iPhone 4 OS will be here - along with its carrier device the iPhone 4G - by mid-July. That these events will herald a revolution in mobile telephony is unarguable, and as devices get smarter and more functional, the once far-fetched vision of augmented reality is now right at our doorstep. With the convergence of devices accelerating, there are exciting times ahead, when you can expect your handheld to do everything from social networking to

shopping, browsing to gaming, and productivity to displaying and recording 3D.

Entry-level Business phones

Blackberry Curve 8520

The Curve 8520 is Blackberry's answer to the masses that clamoured for a more affordable morsel. Unfortunately, it's price, or rather, lack of it, shows. The Curve 8520 cannot hold a candle to the other Blackberry phones in terms of materials used in construction or build quality. It's not shoddy by any means, but the partially translucent material used on the front body isn't the most appealing. The battery cover is decent and while it's not as sturdy as some of the other Blackberry devices (that aren't known for well built battery covers), it should suffice, as long as you're not too rough on it. There's no chrome bezel too - while this might be a good thing for longevity, for the pesky things are known for fall off after a couple of years of daily wear and tear, but this is fond goodbye to some much needed eye-candy as well.

The keypad on the Curve 8520 is identical to the one on the Curve 8900 - these keypads actually feel better than the ones on the costlier models, thanks to the slight segregation of the keys, although

after awhile of using both, we seemed to get similar speeds.

The Curve 8520 offers good signal reception, but it's not as good as the other Blackberry handsets, and way behind our benchmark Nokia handsets - we noticed slight distortion in zone 2. The loudspeaker is plain mediocre - distortion even at lower volumes is not very acceptable and it's only mildly worse than the other Blackberry handsets. The handsfree kit offers decent clarity. Music quality on the handsfree kit is good, but not up to the mark compared to some multimedia phones.

Verdict

Its main plus point is the price - at Rs. 15,000, the Curve 8520 is a dream come true for



BlackBerry Curve 8520

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